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WEM Weekly Summary · 20 September 2026

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Disclosure: *Former-employer disclosure: NiCE is a former employer of the author. All NiCE research here is public-source only; no LinkedIn queries or visits were made for NiCE or Cognyte. The parent report is published at <https://productbeacon.agency/research/state-of-wem-2026/>.*

Workforce Engagement Management (WEM) covers the software that schedules, measures, coaches and assists contact-centre staff, and increasingly the AI agents working beside them.

This week's main developments

- Salesforce told investors that customers adopting AI agents buy somewhat fewer seats yet spend 1.5 to 2 times more. It also said its own contact-centre service goes live in October.
- A California bill reached the Governor that would require large companies to try, in good faith, to connect customers to a human within 15 minutes. It joins the three workplace-AI bills already awaiting action by 30 September.
- CallMiner ended a twelve-week silence and now describes itself as a customer experience (CX) automation company. Forrester ranked it and Cresta against survey vendors for the first time.
- Mercado Libre was named as a customer by two autonomous-service vendors, Decagon and Wonderful, on the same day.
- No acquisition, funding round, earnings report or executive move surfaced among the tracked vendors.

Salesforce tells investors fewer seats can still mean more revenue

Salesforce held its investor session on 16 September, during its Dreamforce conference. The figures below are from the company's presentation.

- Salesforce describes a customer stage where AI agents are adopted in support "with some seat optimization." It reports those customers spend 1.5 to 2 times more overall.
- Help for employees is sold as a higher-priced seat. Agents that serve customers directly are charged by credits, pay-as-you-go, outcomes or a spending commitment.
- Premium seat editions grew from 1% of licences in early 2024 to 5% now. Salesforce reports more than \$1 billion in premium licence revenue and a 60 to 80% price uplift.
- Salesforce also reports growth in Service seats. Revenue guidance was repeated, not raised.
- The presentation gave no standalone Agentforce revenue figure, no Service seat count and no change to per-conversation prices.
- **Why it matters:** Five9 made the same argument to investors on 11 September. Two public vendors now say seat numbers can fall while customer spending rises. Both are describing their own customers; neither figure is audited.

Salesforce's contact-centre service is due in October

- CX Today reports Salesforce said on stage that its contact-centre service is scheduled to go live in October. Salesforce has not published a release confirming the date.

- Salesforce first announced Agentforce Contact Center in March. It combines telephony, customer records and AI agents in one system.
- Salesforce reports that Casey, its own help agent, has resolved five million conversations on its help site.
- Salesforce now sells Fin, acquired on 10 September, as a named agent beside Casey. It reports Fin resolves 79% of the conversations it sees for Anthropic.
- **Watch:** whether the October launch arrives with a price, and how Salesforce positions it against telephony partners Genesys, Five9 and NiCE.

Other Dreamforce announcements

- **Koa:** Salesforce's first in-house reasoning model for Agentforce, built on an NVIDIA model. Salesforce claims three times fewer errors on its own benchmark.
- **Agentforce Coworker:** the assistant for employees reached 100,000 users in its first 35 days, according to Salesforce. No price change accompanied it.
- **Transportation Security Administration:** Salesforce reports the agency's agent handles about 100,000 traveller conversations a month and resolves 96% of routine questions.
- **Adecco:** Salesforce reports the staffing group handled 2.6 million candidate interactions with its agents and saved recruiters 35% of their time.

Seat-plus-credits pricing is spreading

- Salesforce's three editions list at \$195, \$395 and \$550 per user per month. Each includes a yearly allowance of AI credits. Salesforce announced them on 3 September and showed them to investors this week.
- Moor Insights & Strategy called the bundle "an interesting hedge." Salesforce kept its credit system and its \$2 per conversation price.
- MarketBeat reports HubSpot told analysts it will keep moving to "seats and credits." Seats cover employees; credits pay for work done by agents.
- HubSpot is reportedly testing a simpler version with new customers in the Nordics and Benelux. Its own 16 September release contains no price.
- No tracked vendor returned from per-outcome pricing to per-seat pricing. The Fin and Zendesk price pages show no change.
- **Our view:** outcome pricing is not retreating. Large vendors are wrapping AI usage inside a seat price, so the buyer still signs for seats.

California adds a customer-service chatbot bill

AB 1609 reached the Governor on 14 September. It is neither signed nor vetoed. Like the three workplace-AI bills, it becomes law unless vetoed by 30 September.

- It applies to businesses with more than \$500 million in yearly revenue serving California residents.
- A covered business may not present a chatbot as a human. It must offer a simple way to ask for a human agent during business hours.
- It must make a good-faith effort to connect the customer to a human within 15 minutes, or offer an appointment within one business day.
- Hold time should stay under 15 minutes per hold and one hour in total.
- Penalties reach \$5,000 for a first violation and \$10,000 after that. Public prosecutors enforce it; customers cannot sue.
- Telecom and water utilities, business-to-business lines, hospitals and outages are exempt.
- **Why it matters:** this would be the first tracked law to set a minimum for human availability in large contact centres. Plans that assume almost no human staff would need to account for it.

The three workplace-AI bills are still unsigned

- AB 1883 (emotion inference and neural data), SB 947 (automated discipline and firing) and SB 951 (AI layoff notices) remain with the Governor.
- The Governor's 18 September batch acted on 106 bills. None of these was among them.
- Some secondary trackers list AB 1883 as signed. The official record shows it is not.

Other regulatory developments

- **United Kingdom:** a parliamentary human-rights committee report on AI cites union evidence of tools flagging call-centre workers for failing to “upsell.” The Government has two months to respond.
- **Colorado:** the revised automated-decision rules are due by 23 September and had not been published when checked.
- **Connecticut:** AI disclosure in mass-layoff notices starts on 1 October. The state's notice page does not yet mention AI, and no form has surfaced.
- **European Union:** no enforcement action on workplace emotion recognition surfaced in the official sources checked.

CallMiner repositions around automation

- CallMiner published its first press releases since 23 June. It now opens by calling itself the leader in “CX automation powered by deep conversation intelligence.”
- Its yearly survey with Vanson Bourne reports 99% of customer-service organisations use automation. Only 24% say it delivers very positive experiences. The release gives no sample size.
- The same survey reports 95% say human agents add more value than automation in at least one type of interaction.

- CallMiner says Forrester named it a Strong Performer in customer-feedback platforms, its first appearance in that ranking.
- CX Today reports Medallia is the only Leader and Cresta is a Contender in the same ranking.
- **Our view:** conversation analytics is now being graded as an alternative to surveys. CallMiner and Observe.AI both moved from scoring conversations to acting on the scores within two weeks.

Mercado Libre appears on two vendors' customer lists

- Decagon opened a São Paulo office and named Mercado Libre as a customer for Portuguese-language voice agents replacing phone menus. It gave no volumes.
- Wonderful published a Mercado Libre Mexico case study the same day: three agents on WhatsApp, built in ten weeks.
- Wonderful reports roughly 99% of conversations handled without a person "in its first runs." That is an early figure on a small base.
- **Our view:** a large buyer is splitting work between vendors by use case and country, not standardising on one.

Other company developments

- **NiCE:** reports Merlin Entertainments raised issue resolution from 75% to 95% and call answer rate from 78% to 93% over a year on its CXone platform.
- **Sierra:** says it passed an independent audit against AIUC-1, a new safety standard for AI agents. Testing recurs at least quarterly.
- **Parloa:** launched regional deployment zones that keep transcripts, logs and backups inside one region.
- **Zendesk:** launched industry-specific and custom AI agents, starting with commerce. It reports one million custom-agent runs in seven weeks and gave no price.
- **Five9:** shares fell 5.7% on 18 September without company news. It has published nothing since its 11 September investor remarks.
- **Teneo AI:** the Stockholm-listed contact-centre AI vendor cleared its debt by issuing its lender about 940 million new shares, roughly 30% of the enlarged company.
- **LanguageLine:** last week's Capital & Main report on interpreter scheduling was republished by Daily Kos. No new reporting appeared, and no response from NiCE or further employer statement has surfaced.
- **Verint and Calabrio:** no press release in 26 days, and no combined product announced.

What to watch

- **California, by 30 September:** action on AB 1609, AB 1883, SB 947 and SB 951. Without a veto, each becomes law.
- **Colorado, 23 September:** the revised automated-decision rules.
- **Connecticut, 1 October:** whether the state publishes a layoff-notice form that covers AI.
- **Salesforce, October:** the contact-centre launch and any price attached to it.
- **Listen Labs:** Salesforce's reported acquisition talks remain unconfirmed, with no agreement or denial.
- **Prediction updates:** the next full check of the annual report's eighteen predictions is due in early October.
- **New companies surfaced, not yet tracked:** Solidroad and Unwrap (training built from conversation findings), Teneo AI, and AIUC (the agent-safety standard body).

Sources

Detailed citations

Company and official sources

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- [Salesforce: investor presentation](#)
- [Salesforce: Coworker and Alforce](#)
- [Salesforce: Koa model](#)
- [Salesforce: named agents including Fin](#)
- [Salesforce: Transportation Security Administration](#)
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- [California: AB 1609 status](#)
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- [California Governor: 18 September bill actions](#)
- [UK Parliament: human rights and AI report](#)
- [Colorado: AI rulemaking](#)
- [CallMiner: yearly survey](#)
- [CallMiner: Forrester ranking](#)

- Decagon: Brazil expansion
- Wonderful: Mercado Libre case study
- NiCE: Merlin Entertainments
- Sierra: AIUC-1 certification
- Parloa: deployment zones
- Zendesk: specialised AI agents
- Teneo AI: refinancing completed
- Solidroad and Unwrap: partnership

Reporting and analysis

- CX Today: Dreamforce announcements
- CX Today: Forrester customer-feedback ranking
- Moor Insights & Strategy: Dreamforce notes
- MarketBeat: HubSpot analyst day
- Quiver Quantitative: Five9 share move
- Daily Kos: LanguageLine republication